

Payal Chand

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EDUCATION

London, UK Imperial College London Sept 2025 - Sept 2026

- **Master's Degree** – (M.Sc., 1 year), Design with Behaviour Science
- **Coursework** – Transdisciplinary Research Methods, Design Psychology, Inferential and Causal Statistics, Responsible Engineering and Design Innovation, Design Engineering, Design of Visual Systems
- **Clubs** – Impact at Imperial, FemTech, Fellwanderers

WORK EXPERIENCE

Learning Experience Designer AutoVRse, Bengaluru Jun 2024 – Nov 2024

- **Led 0→1 XR PoCs for 3 B2B clients**, uncovering adoption gaps & converting pilots into long-term client partnerships
- **Designed 20+ VR modules** end-to-end with multimodal and language accessibility, for varied industry and user needs
- **Reduced storyboarding time 7X**, from 35 hrs to 5 hrs, transforming manual workflows into modular templates
- Concepted and prototyped narrative-led MR experiences from initial idea to polished demo, extracting actionable insights
- **Partnered closely with PMs, engineers, and clients** to iterate fast and deliver polished prototypes under tight timelines

UX & Interaction Designer EI Lab, IIT Guwahati Sept 2023 – May 2024

- **Established foundational interaction patterns** for India's 1st government VR modules within an undefined space
- **Conducted usability studies with 100+ novice users** to validate novel interactions and resolve comprehension gaps
- **Translated research into a reusable VR design system**, defining navigation, logic, and interaction standards
- **Collaborated** closely with **Unity engineers** to implement behavioural logic while preserving design intent in production
- **Established sequential multimodal feedback standards** to optimise learner focus and minimise cognitive overload
- **Resulting framework, scaled nationally**, now powers **Gyan Dhara**, expanding to **20+ PM SHRI government schools**

Co-Founder ClosetForYou, Mumbai Dec 2021 - Dec 2022

- **Co-founded and led design** for ClosetForYou, a sustainable thrift platform focused on affordable, circular fashion
- **Designed social-first purchase journeys**, optimising Instagram as the primary channel for discovery and conversion
- **Scaled a 0 → 300+ member community in 6 weeks** through targeted storytelling and feedback-driven engagement
- **Owned end-to-end experience**, balancing brand identity and inventory presentation with lean operational constraints

PROJECTS

Interaction States for Expressive Voice AI | Hume AI Jan 2026 - Feb 2026

- **Identified 4 systemic failure modes** in Hume EVI-3's turn-taking model through **structured interaction analysis**
- Proposed replacing single-trigger response commitment with **continuous floor state evaluation, Interaction Bracket Evaluation → Behaviour Selection**
- **Designed a 3-state floor classifier**, reading pace, pause, and context to **gate system behaviour** before response commitment
- Created **confidence-weighted response policy** (Backchannel→Wait→Full Response) by scaling outputs with floor certainty

Cross-Cultural Buddy System | Imperial College London Feb 2026 - Mar 2026

- Chinese international students default to ethnic clustering **due to unmet SDT needs** as root drivers via COM-B
- **Designed interest-based matching by operationalising homophily** with SDT competence & relatedness from first contact
- **Structured a 2:1 pairing ratio satisfying Intergroup Contact Theory**, for equal-status contact with institutional embedding
- Proposed quasi-experimental **validation across 3 points testing need fulfilment as a mediator** of sociocultural adaptation

SKILLS

- **Design** – Interaction Design, Spatial Design, Conceptualisation, Behavioural Design, Human Centred Design, Design Systems
- **Tools & Systems** – Figma, Figjam, Adobe Illustrator, Autodesk, Bezi, ShapesXR, ChatGPT, Claude, Microsoft Office Suite, Google Workspace, Notion, Python, R, HTML, CSS, React
- **Research** – Literature Review, User Interview, Diary Study, Focus Group Studies, Contextual Inquiry, Think Aloud Method, Consequence Scanning, COM-B, PRIME, ABC, ISM

ADDITIONAL ACHIEVEMENTS

- Attended a 15-day UX workshop and was **awarded a job offer** to work on Evam **out of 20 participants**
- **Seminar speaker** at the Rotaract Club of Thane Imperial, sharing insights about modern UX practices
- **Interned to raise funds** at a child welfare NGO named Muskurahat Foundation